

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♠

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10

♥ 4 2

♦ K J 7 4 3 2

♣ 9 3

♠ A K 5 3

♥ Q 10

♦ Q 6 5

♣ A 7 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 7 6 2

♥ A 7 5

♦ A 9

♣ K Q J 10

♠ 9 4

♥ K J 9 8 6 3

♦ 10 8

♣ 8 6 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by North

North opens 1NT.

With 6 ♥s of your own you can be sure that your side has at least an 8-card ♥ fit. So playing ♥s will be better than playing notrump. You bid 2♦, transferring partner to ♥s. Partner says 2♥.

Of course you pass. You only have 6 points so there is no chance for game. You just wanted to reach the best partscore and figured 2♥ would be safer than 1NT.

As you can see from partner's hand you made the right call. Played in ♥s your hand will produce five tricks. At notrump your hand will win only one trick if the defenders hold up their ♥A just one time.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 8 7 6 4

♥ Q 4

♦ K 6 3

♣ J 9 2

♠ 9 2

♥ K 8 7 6

♦ 10 9 5

♣ A 10 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 10 5

♥ A 5

♦ Q J 8 4

♣ K Q 7 3

♠ A J 3

♥ J 10 9 3 2

♦ A 7 2

♣ 8 6

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by East

You might revalue your hand up to 10 points now that an 8-card fit has been discovered, but it is a really poor 10 points. Also, remember the warning about Responder revaluing for short suits.

As you can see, a 4♠ contract would have no chance, losing 1 trick in each side suit and at least 1 ♠.

East's 1NT opening shows 15-17 points. What is your bid?

With 9 points you have an invitational strength hand. With a 5-card ♠ suit you should transfer partner to ♠s by bidding 2♥. Partner dutifully responds 2♠.

With this next bid you must tell partner you only have invitational strength, and inform him that you have only 5 ♠s (remember, your transfer promised **AT LEAST** 5). The bid that says both of these facts at once is 2NT. Partner comes back with 3♠. What say you?

You say pass. Partner did not accept your invitation to game so he must have a minimum hand. His correction to 3♠ indicates he has three of the suit and wants to play in ♠s rather than notrump.